

Aesop, Herbal Deodorant

Packed plane cabins can make for sweaty passengers, but this natural deodorant will ensure you contribute only a pleasant odour. Common ingredients such as aluminium and talc are eschewed for plant-based alternatives such as witch hazel and zinc ricinoleate, which tackle bacteria while leaving you smelling fresh as a daisy. The crisp, clean smell is gender-neutral, and the 50ml bottle ensures it won't be confiscated at security.

NZ\$49, aesop.com



Wacaco, Minipresso NS2

Don't let sub-par coffee leave you with a bad taste in your mouth on holiday. Come prepared with this dinky espresso machine. Standing just 13cm high and weighing 290g, the Minipresso MS2 can nonetheless generate enough pressure to pull a good shot of espresso. The winner of a coveted Red Dot Design Award, the machine is hand-powered, requiring no electricity or battery. Plus you can use your favourite Nespresso capsules.

NZ\$89.90, wacaco.com



Shopping



Pentax, WG-90 Digital Camera

Want to get some great shots on your next adventure, but don't want to risk damaging your phone in the process? This rugged digital camera could be just the trick. Waterproof to a depth of 14 metres, making it great for underwater photography, it'll also withstand temperatures as low as -10C, falls of up to 1.6 metres, and crushes of up to 100kgf (kilogram forces).

NZ\$795, pbtech.co.nz

Yu Mei, Claudia Tote

Nothing says 'I mean business' on a work trip like a quality carry-on bag, and this sleek, black tote from Dunedin-based Yu Mei fits the bill perfectly. Made from soft deer nappa leather, it's big enough to serve as an overnight bag, yet small enough to stow under the plane seat in front of you. It's also super-easy to carry when you have a suitcase in tow thanks to a travel sleeve that slides over suitcase handles and converts into an external pocket.

NZ\$1495, yumeibrand.com



PRODUCT

Review

Fujifilm's latest mid-range camera has landed in New Zealand, and, as *Nile Bijoux* discovers, it's the best standalone travel camera available right now.

Called the X-T50, the camera uses an APS-C sensor, which is smaller than your standard 35mm full-frame DSLR. This generally means images are more cropped but the cameras themselves can be smaller and lighter (this one weighs just 438g without a lens), making them better for travelling. These cameras are generally better for street photography, as the resulting images are cropped in more than a full-size DSLR, but they can be used for landscapes as well.

Fujifilm's sensor in the X-T50 is a 40.2 megapixel unit, which means images are taken at extremely high resolution. The autofocus system has also been upgraded, able to detect everything from animals and birds to cars, motorcycles, bicycles, airplanes, trains, insects and drones.

But the biggest seller of the X-T50 is Fujifilm's 'Film Simulation' modes. These apply what is effectively a filter to reproduce Fujifilm's iconic analogue film stocks in the camera, with 20 on hand to choose from. The wheel on the top-left of the camera switches between 12 of those, three



Fujifilm
X-T50

options being customisable and another turning the simulations off entirely.

While the thought of bespoke filters might turn you off a bit, these are far more sophisticated and high-quality than the ones on Instagram. Velvia, a film I loved back in the days of dabbling with analogue photography, is represented exactly as I remember it with big contrast values perfect for reproducing colour. Classic Chrome, Nostalgia Negative and the new Reala Ace were also favourites while I had the camera.

The photos produced right out of the camera are seriously incredible. The resolution is massive, so if you need to crop in further you can without losing quality, while flicking between each film mode is quite exciting, if slightly time consuming. You have to do it in the moment though, there's currently no way to add a filter after taking a photo without editing software.

If you want to record video, the X-T50 can do that too, with 1080p and 4K resolutions supported at up to 60fps, while 1080p recordings can be pushed up to 240fps for slow-motion.

The screen on the back is good too, although it's quite reflective, which makes viewing photos in direct sunlight a bit of a pain. It's a tilting unit, which means you can get the camera right down low and still see what you're taking a photo of.

All in, the X-T50 is a superb piece of kit for travellers or those looking to kickstart photography as a hobby. It's relatively affordable at about the \$3000 mark, compact, gorgeous to look at, and those film simulations are so good they bump the Fujifilm model above the competition.

See: fujifilm.com/nz/en